focus on America and believed the ISI was wasting jihadis as cannon fodder in Kashmir. His transition from ISI-sponsored militancy to al-Qaeda would be repeated by a number of Pakistani militants after 9/11. By then Barot already had worked as a trainer in Afghanistan before becoming an overseas al-Qaeda operative, in which capacity he scouted targets in the US from 2000–2001. This reconnaissance was done before 9/11, but was not briefed to al-Qaeda leaders in Pakistan until 2004 by which time the US was a very different and more difficult operating environment.[166] Barot was in the UK by 2004, working on a plan to explode limousines in underground car parks using gas cylinders and to bomb the London underground. Soon after the discovery of his surveillance material in a Pakistani safe house, British police arrested Barot who admitted to conducting the surveillance and to involvement in terrorist plots against the UK.[167]

David Hicks's experience illustrates the ease with which Westerners were able to use Lashkar to connect with al-Qaeda and, once again, that connections existed between the two prior to 9/11. An Australian who traveled to Pakistan in 1999 in search of adventure, Hicks soon found himself among Lashkar recruiters in Lahore. Not long after that he was in the mountains training with the group. Hicks spent several months doing so, before moving on to a madrasa where he studied Arabic and the Quran. Hicks reportedly asked Lashkar for and received a letter of introduction to al-Qaeda. He crossed the border into Afghanistan in January 2001 and presented himself, along with his letter of introduction, to Ibn al-Sheikh al-Libi [born Ali Mohammad al-Fakheri], a senior al-Qaeda member who sent him to the al-Faruq camp.[168] His lawyer confirmed that, while in Afghanistan, Hicks attended three separate training camps and sat in on lectures given by Osama bin Laden.[169] Hicks was captured in Afghanistan after 9/11 and sent to Guantanamo Bay. In 2007 he plead guilty to providing material support for terrorism and was sentenced to a seven year jail term by a military tribunal, with all but nine months suspended. As part of his plea deal Hicks was repatriated to Australia to serve the remaining months of his sentence.[170]

Omar Khyam, a British national of Pakistani descent, also gravitated toward al-Qaeda, but not until after 9/11. He went to Pakistan in 2000 seeking training and soon found himself in Lashkar's camps.[171] There is no